Observational Studies 0 (2026): 1–1 Accepted Jan 1 2026; Published Jan 1 2026

The Accuracy of Psychohistorical Equations for Predicting the Results of Observational Studies

Hari Seldon hseldon@streeling.edu
Department of Psychohistory
Streeling University
Trantor, Center of the Galaxy 94830, Galactic Empire

Mitch A. Taylor mtaylor@pacifictech.edu
Department of Physics
Pacific Tech
Los Angeles, CA 90001, USA

Abstract

Psychohistory combines history, sociology, and mathematical statistics to make general predictions about the future behavior of very large groups of people. There are two axioms of psychohistory: (1) the population whose behaviour is modeled should be sufficiently large; (2) the population should remain in ignorance of the results of the application of psychohistorical analyses. In this paper, we use psychohistory to predict the results of large observational studies.

Keywords: Mass Action, Prime Radiant, Survival Analysis

1. Introduction

Psychohistory depends on the idea that, while one cannot foresee the actions of a particular individual, the laws of statistics as applied to large groups of people can predict the general flow of future events (Breiman, 2001). As an analogy, consider a gas. It is difficult to predict the motion of a single molecule in a gas, but we can predict the mass action of the gas to a high level of accuracy. In this paper, we apply psychohistory to predict the results of observational studies. Hastie et al. (2009) defined an observational study as an empiric investigation in which "...the objective is to elucidate cause-and-effect relationships[in which] it is not feasible to use controlled experimentation, in the sense of being able to impose the procedures or treatments whose effects it is desired to discover, or to assign subjects at random to different procedures."

...

Acknowledgments

We would like to acknowledge support for this project from Obi-Wan Kenobi of the Galactic Republic.

Appendix A.

In this appendix we prove the following theorem from Section 6.2:

...

References

Leo Breiman. Statistical modeling: The two cultures (with comments and a rejoinder by the author). *Statistical Science*, 16(3):199–231, 8 2001. ISSN 0883-4237, 2168-8745. doi: 10.1214/ss/1009213726. MR: MR1874152 Zbl: 1059.62505.

Trevor Hastie, Robert Tibshirani, and Jerome Friedman. *The Elements of Statistical Learning*. Springer New York, 2 edition edition, 8 2009. 00007.